St Ignatius College
Riverview

2013

HSC TASK 1
EXAMINATION

Business Studies

Total marks - 40

General Instructions

- Exam time: 60 minutes
- Write using a blue or black pen
- Board-approved calculators may be used
- Write your name and teacher's initials in the spaces provided
  Brake MXB
  Byrne AJB
  Robertson MXR
  Walker LAW
  Walsh SMW

Section I
40 marks
- Attempt Questions 1-4
- Allow about 60 minutes

I

2013 HSC TASK 1 EXAMINATION

Business Studies

Student Number

Teacher Initials

Section I

40 marks
Attempt Questions 1–4
Allow about 60 minutes for this section

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Question 1 (6 marks)

(a) How are the operations of a business interdependent on ONE other key business function? **2**

(b) Explain how using the strategic approach to differentiation of a good/service may impact upon a business' performance objectives. **4**

End of Question 1

Student Number

Section I (continued)

Teacher Initials

Question 2 (10 marks)

'Solarite' is a company that uses leading edge technology to produce Australian made solar panels to provide alternative energy sources for major TNC's. They rely on government assistance although have faced recent scrutiny form the public due to high costs and the time taken to repair products under warranty.

(a) Describe THREE influences that have impacted on SOLARITE. **6**

Influence 1

Influence 2

Influence 3

Question 2 continues on the next page.

(b) Discuss the impacts for business of embracing corporate social responsibility? **4**

End of Question 2

Student Number

Teacher Initials

Section I (continued)

Question 3 (10 marks)

Wong Tong Noodle Bar Pty Ltd is a restaurant that has made a decision to cook their meals directly in front of the customer rather than behind kitchen doors. They believe that they might develop a competitive advantage over their competitors using this approach.

(a) Distinguish between transformed and transforming resources and provide an example of EACH in the context of the stimulus above. **4**

(b) Identify which influence on the transformation process is most relevant to Wong Tong's decision to cook in front of the customers and explain ONE implication this decision may have on the operations process. **3**

Identify Influence

Explain Implication

(c) Define the term warranty and explain ONE potential benefit to a company that decides to issue one. **3**

End of Question 3

Student Number

Teacher Initials

Section I (continued)

Question 4 (14 marks)

Stig is an operations manager at a furniture manufacturer in Melbourne. They have been selling uniquely designed, contemporary furniture in the global market for two years, with strong sales particularly in the United Arab Emirates. However, all inputs are sourced in Australia. The business has recently suffered a loss of market share as a new competitor from Brazil now offers similar unique furniture at a cheaper price and with faster lead times.

(a) Describe TWO operations performance objectives that Stig should aim to achieve given the influences on the business. **4**

Question 4 continues on the next page.

(b) Discuss the use of outsourcing for Stig's business. **4**

(c) Analyse how the strategy of quality management assists businesses to sustain a competitive advantage. **6**